

The Lost Celebration

OFFLINE BINDER INDEX

A 2024 fifth-edition birthday one-shot for three level 3 heroes

BINDER SETUP

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PRINT CHECKLIST

- ☐ Print pages 2-26 single-sided for the GM binder.
- ☐ Print pages 27-51 single-sided; hand players only pages called for by the GM guide.
- ☐ Print pages 37-44 on cardstock if available, then cut on the marked lines.
- ☐ Keep pages 20-26 behind the GM screen. Put the quick rules page beside the dice.

BIRTHDAY QUEST - GAME MASTER'S GUIDE + PLAYER PACK

The Lost Celebration of Bellweather

A fantasy one-shot about rebuilding a forgotten town tradition—without knowing what it will become

3 HEROES	Level 3 QUICK-PLAY	3½-4½h RUN TIME	Age 13 AGE-TUNED
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THE PROMISE

Bellweather's grand celebration item was lost generations ago. The heroes must recover four cryptically named components, survive creatures that want the tradition forgotten, and rebuild the mystery beneath a sealed stone dome.

What is included

- A complete scene-by-scene mystery quest with read-aloud text and an expected three-and-a-half-to-four-and-a-half-hour run of show.
- Ingredient hunts featuring battle, stealth, negotiation, and a fail-forward reconstruction finale.
- Three simplified level 3 heroes: a protector, a sneak, and a starry bard.
- Printable handouts, official 2024 character sheets, quick rules, keyed maps, tokens, and complete creature stat blocks.
- Experience, difficulty, and two-player adjustments so the game stays fun rather than fragile.

Assumptions

This packet uses the 2024 fifth-edition D&D rules for three level 3 heroes and one Game Master. The mystery should feel adventurous rather than childish. Use DC 12 for routine challenges and DC 13 when pressure matters.

QUICK PERSONALIZE

Handwrite the birthday hero's name on the commission. Place a covered cake nearby if desired. Players may guess freely; NPCs cannot confirm the answer before the Founder's Hearth opens.

Game Master's Quick Start

You can run the adventure directly from these pages. For each scene: read the boxed text, ask 'What do you do?', let everyone answer, then call for a roll only when failure would be interesting. If you forget a rule, choose DC 12, make a fair ruling, and keep the story moving.

Before everyone arrives

- Print the official hero sheets, hero action cards, spell cards, maps, tokens, component cards, loot cards, trackers, and Player Quick Rules page.
- Gather one d20 per player plus d4, d6, d8, and d10 dice. Cut out the creature, component, reward, Heroic Inspiration, condition, and hearth-rune pieces. Give each player Heroic Inspiration.
- This age 13 version uses DC 12 for routine checks and DC 13 for risky or dramatic checks. If everyone is new, DC 12 throughout is fine.
- Privately ask whether anything should stay out of the story. Keep scares cartoony and allow anyone to pause the game without explanation.
- Let the birthday child choose a hero first. Give the remaining heroes equal chances to solve problems and make decisions.

Four-hour run of show (expect 3½ to 4½ hours)

Time	Scene	What matters
0:00	Welcome and hero choice	Introduce characters, explain the d20, and present the restoration tablet.
0:20	Act 1: Briar Farm	Battle or outwit evil moon-hens to recover the Dawn Pearls.
1:00	Break 1 / Short Rest	Pause, recap clues, spend Hit Dice, and recover Short Rest features.
1:15	Act 2A: Storehouse	Sneak past guards or earn their trust to collect Lantern Gold.
2:00	Act 2B: Mill and Honey Steps	Solve the chute puzzle; bargain or battle for Sunmeal and Cloudsweet. Take Break 2 as a Long Rest after all four components are recovered.

Time	Scene	What matters
3:15	Act 3: Founder's Hearth	Combine the components and defend four hearth runes from Cindermaw.
4:20	Epilogue	Open the dome, reveal the cake, award the Restorer's Medal, and celebrate.

The three golden rules

1. Say yes to good ideas. If an action is plausible and fun, let it work or call for a DC 10-13 check.
2. Failure changes the situation; it never stops the adventure. Reveal the clue, but add a cost, complication, or funny consequence.
3. End fights early when the outcome is clear. Enemies surrender, flee, or tumble into harmless feathers and soot at 0 hit points.

HEROIC INSPIRATION

Each hero starts with it. Immediately after rolling any die, a hero may expend it to reroll that die and must use the new roll. A hero can have only one Heroic Inspiration at a time.

GM-ONLY SECTION

Secrets, Suspects, and the Lost Recipe

What really happened

Bellweather once welcomed every new year with a magnificent shared creation, but a fire destroyed the guildhall and its records. Mayor Mallow recovered a coded tablet naming Dawn Pearls, Sunmeal, Lantern Gold, and Cloudsweet. They are eggs, flour, food-grade seed oil, and sugar. Cindermaw was born in the guildhall fire and believes the rekindled hearth will destroy it. Players may guess the answer; NPCs cannot confirm it until the dome opens.

THE REVEAL

Use component names, but let players guess freely. NPCs genuinely do not know. A correct prediction earns advantage on one Founder's Hearth check; the magical finished creation remains the true reveal.

People and creatures

Name	First impression	What they want / know
Mayor Mallow	Flustered historian with a soot-marked tablet	Wants the lost tradition restored but cannot read the component names.
Captain Wick	Suspicious lamplighter guard with an enormous key ring	Knows brightseed oil is edible; fears thieves are working for Cinderdaw.
Cinderdaw	A coal-black drake leaking sparks and soot	Fears the restored hearth will destroy it. Can become its protector instead.
Moon-hens	Goose-sized black chickens with silver combs	Guard the Dawn Pearls; can be calmed with feed, rhythm, or firm handling.
Sprig	A brave lantern sprite	Optional helper for two heroes or a struggling party.

Clues the heroes cannot miss

- The Dawn Pearls are warm, speckled, and fiercely guarded by enormous black hens.
- Lantern Gold is pressed brightseed oil. Captain Wick knows the gold variety is safe for food; the blue and black lamp fuels are dangerous.
- Sunmeal resembles golden dust and Cloudsweet resembles pale quartz. Smell or taste can reveal more, but never require a player to do so.
- The reconstruction tablet repeatedly mentions mixing, rising warmth, and a final crown—but never names the object.

Useful difficulty numbers

DC	Use it when...	Examples
10	The idea is sensible or the players are younger	Spot an obvious trail, calm a silly creature, leap a short gap.
12	Default challenge	Notice sootling tracks, calm one hen, identify a marked flask.

DC	Use it when...	Examples
13	The attempt is risky, dramatic, or under time pressure	Cross guarded rafters, solve a rune under pressure, resist Soot Breath.

GM-ONLY SECTION

Act 1: The Broken Celebration

Goal: introduce the heroes, reveal the missing tradition, and recover Dawn Pearls. Target time: 60 minutes. Take Break 1 as a Short Rest after the tablet points toward the storehouse.

READ ALOUD

Bellweather Square should be bursting with music, banners, and cheering. Instead, an empty stone pedestal stands beneath a scorched cloth. Mayor Mallow holds up a cracked tablet. 'Heroes, our oldest celebration has been lost so long that nobody remembers what belongs here. The tablet names four pieces. Recover them before tomorrow's sunset, and perhaps the Founder's Hearth can rebuild what we forgot.'

Give everyone a spotlight question

- What strange festival tradition does your hero insist is completely normal?
- What useful tool did your hero bring that nobody else thought to pack?
- Why does rebuilding Bellweather's lost celebration matter to your hero?

Reward a confident or funny answer with a cheer. Every hero already begins with Heroic Inspiration, using the standard 2024 rule.

The mayor's commission

READ ALOUD

At Briar Farm, the barn doors explode outward in a cyclone of feathers. Six enormous black chickens patrol a stone nest. Their eyes glow ember-red. One scratches a warning into the dirt: CLUCK OFF. Behind it rest three warm, speckled objects exactly the size of the tablet's first hollow.

Challenge: Battle the Briar Farm brood

Six magically enraged moon-hens surround a stone nest holding three Dawn Pearls. The group may attempt 4 successes before 2 setbacks or enter combat. In combat, use three hens and the silver-

combed rooster; add two hens after round 2 only if the heroes are winning easily. Calming the rooster ends the encounter.

- Athletics: hold a gate shut, tip a feed trough, or shield an ally from a charging hen.
- Acrobatics or Stealth: cross the rafters, slip behind the brood, or snatch an egg between patrols.
- Animal Handling: imitate the old farmer's calming whistle or scatter feed in a safe direction.
- Investigation or Perception: spot the true nest, the rooster's signal, or a loose fence board.
- Magic, Performance, or another clever plan: judge by the idea, usually DC 10-13.

FAIL FORWARD

On success, the heroes recover the Dawn Pearls cleanly. On a mixed result, they still escape with all three, but a furious rooster follows them and loudly ruins their next attempt at Stealth. Either way, the tablet reveals the clue to Lantern Gold.

Moon-hen — quick combat

AC 12; HP 7 each; Speed 30 ft.; Initiative +2. Furious Peck: +4 to hit, 1d4 + 2 piercing. Once per round, only the rooster may use Wing Flurry: creatures within 5 ft. make a DC 12 Dex save or take 1d4 + 2 bludgeoning and fall prone. The brood flees when three hens fall or the rooster is calmed with a DC 13 Animal Handling or Performance action.

First component recovered

The Dawn Pearls reveal the storehouse clue. If the heroes calmed the rooster, give them the Silver Feather loot card: one use causes the Frightened condition to end on every hero. A soot-black drake silhouette watches from a distant chimney, then vanishes.

READ ALOUD — THE TABLET AWAKENS

As the third Dawn Pearl settles into the cracked tablet, silver lines race across its surface. A new sentence burns into view: 'Where watchful eyes guard bottled daylight, claim only the gold that may touch a wooden spoon.' Far across Bellweather, the lamplighter tower flashes once—then goes dark. Ask: 'How do you travel there, and who carries the tablet?'

GM-ONLY SECTION

Act 2: Gold Behind Guarded Doors

Goal: expose the impostor, recover Lantern Gold, solve the windmill, and earn Cloudsweet. Target time: 100-120 minutes. Take Break 2 as an eight-hour Long Rest after all four components are recovered; resume at dawn.

READ ALOUD

The lamplighter storehouse squats beside the city wall, its windows barred and its roof patrolled. Captain Wick checks Mayor Mallow's seal, then lowers his voice. 'The courtyard is safe. The oil room is not. Sootlings can wear a guard's shape, and one of my people casts no shadow. Go quietly. Find the flask marked with a wooden spoon. Trust nobody carrying blue fire.'

Scene A: The Lamplighter Storehouse

Run one shared challenge: 3 successes before 2 setbacks. Ask every hero to describe an approach before anyone repeats a skill. OFFICIAL—work beside Wick and test guards; COVERT—use rafters and the roof vent; BAIT—announce a false target and watch who reacts. Routes can be mixed.

- OFFICIAL: DC 12 Insight, Perception, or Persuasion identifies contradictions, soot tracks, or a missing shadow.
- COVERT: DC 13 Stealth, Acrobatics, or thieves' tools crosses the rafters, opens the vent, or reaches the oil room unseen.
- BAIT: DC 12 Deception, Investigation, Performance, or a clever tool use provokes the impostor or identifies the wooden-spoon seal. After every roll, reveal one useful clue.
- Outcome: at 3 successes, the heroes expose the impostor and preserve Wick's trust. At 2 setbacks, the sootling grabs blue fire and runs; ask every hero for one immediate response. Either way, the correct Lantern Gold is secured. Award Captain's Whistle if no real guard was harmed: once in the finale, one rune is guarded for a full round.

READ ALOUD — LANTERN GOLD RECOVERED

The golden flask bears a tiny wooden-spoon seal. When it touches the tablet, the second symbol shines like sunrise through amber glass. Captain Wick exhales. 'That is the true brightseed oil. Whatever you are restoring, Cindermau is frightened of it.' A new line points toward the abandoned windmill beyond the west gate.

Storehouse scuffle — quick combat

Disguised Sootling — AC 13; HP 13; Speed 30 ft., Climb 20 ft.; Initiative +2. Smudging Claw: +4 to hit, 1d6 + 2 Psychic. Blue-Fire Dash (Recharge 5–6): move up to its Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks. Bellweather Guard — AC 14; HP 11; Spear: +3 to hit, 1d6 + 1 Piercing. Net (1/Day): DC 11 Dexterity save, one Large or smaller creature within 15 feet; failure: Restrained. The target or a creature within 5 feet can take an action and pass a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check to free it. Real guards prefer nets, Help, and grapples.

READ ALOUD — IF THE ALARM SOUNDS

A brass bell CLANGS overhead. Boots pound across the courtyard. One guard smiles far too widely, dissolves into soot, and races for a rack of blue-burning flasks. Captain Wick shouts, 'That one is not mine! Stop it—and keep the blue fire away from the oil!' Ask each player for one immediate action, then roll initiative only if the chase needs it.

FIRST-TIME GM: RUN THE INFILTRATION

Track 3 SUCCESS boxes and 2 SETBACK boxes. Ask every hero for an approach before anyone repeats a skill. Nyx can sneak, Bramble can distract, and Elio can question guards. Reveal one clue after every roll. At 3 successes, expose the impostor cleanly. At 2 setbacks, trigger the fleeing sootling. Never block the correct flask.

Scene B: The Windmill and Honey Steps

READ ALOUD — THE SILENT WINDMILL

The abandoned windmill leans over a field of knee-high gold grass. Its sails are perfectly still, but four brass chutes hum beneath the millstone: RAVEN, SUN, RIVER, and CROWN. When the tablet draws near, three carved clues shine along the floor. Somewhere inside the gears, something heavy waits to be released. Ask: 'Who studies the clues, and who checks the machinery?'

At the abandoned mill, four marked chutes—Raven, Sun, River, and Crown—must be opened in order to release the preserved Sunmeal. Read the three carved clues:

PUZZLE CLUES

RIVER comes before RAVEN. CROWN stands immediately before SUN. RAVEN is neither first nor last.

Answer: River, Raven, Crown, Sun. A wrong choice releases harmless golden dust and reveals another hint. After two wrong tries, River glows. Solving it without a magical hint awards Millkeeper's Gear: after a failed preparation check, turn that failure into a success.

READ ALOUD — THE MILL TURNS

The final chute locks into place. Ancient gears groan, the sails turn despite the still air, and a drawer slides from the millstone. Inside rests a pouch of golden powder marked SUNMEAL. Beneath it is a silver map ending at a stairway of enormous flowers. Tiny winged shapes circle the top. Ask: 'Do you approach openly, hide, or prepare an offering?'

Cloudsweet encounter

READ ALOUD — THE SUGAR SPRITES

The flower stair ends at a garden of glassy blossoms. Three tiny winged figures rise from the petals, each carrying a needle-thin spear. Their leader points at the tablet. 'Ground-walkers took our flowers and never replanted them. Why should we surrender what remembers their sweetness?' Ask: 'What do you say or offer?'

The sprites accept a song, a specific promise to replant their flowers, or a DC 13 Nature, Performance, or Persuasion check. Otherwise, three sprites attack and bargain when two fall. A sincere promise awards

Sprite's Favor. With all four components recovered, the heroes camp beneath the sprites' protective flowers for an eight-hour Long Rest and resume at dawn.

READ ALOUD — CLOUDSWEET EARNED

The last tiny spear lowers. Whether won through a promise, a performance, or hard-earned respect, the sprites pour pale crystals into a flower-shaped pouch. Their leader says, 'Carry the memory kindly—and bring new flowers when you return.' The crystals settle into the tablet's final hollow. All four symbols pulse together, and golden footprints appear on the road toward the ruined guildhall. For one instant the air smells warm and familiar—but the memory slips away before you can name it.

GM-ONLY SECTION

Act 3: The Founder's Hearth

Goal: solve the Four Channels, operate the hearth as a team, and protect the reconstruction from Cinderdaw. Target time: 90-110 minutes including finale and epilogue.

READ ALOUD

The Founder's Hearth waits beneath the ruined guildhall. Four stone channels lead toward a sealed iron dome. As the components approach, words ignite across the tablet: WHAT WAKES. WHAT GIVES FORM. WHAT CARRIES WARMTH. WHAT REMEMBERS JOY. From the chimney comes a frightened scraping sound. 'Let forgotten things stay forgotten.'

Trial 1: The Four Channels

The recovered portions are already magically measured. The heroes connect each to the correct channel using the tablet: 'What wakes enters first. What gives form follows. Warm gold binds what was divided. Memory crowns the work.' Answer: Dawn Pearls, Sunmeal, Lantern Gold, Cloudsweet. After two mistakes, the correct next channel glows.

READ ALOUD — THE FOUR CHANNELS ANSWER

The last component slides into place. Silver light races through all four channels—Pearl, Meal, Gold, then Sweet—and the stone hands around the dome unfold with a deep, patient click. Four action symbols flare on the tablet: COMBINE, STIR, WARM, CROWN. Ask the players to arrange those pieces before choosing their stations.

Trial 2: Operate and Prepare the Hearth

Give out the COMBINE, STIR, WARM, and CROWN pieces. After the heroes identify the order, each takes a station: tablet reader, stone-hand operator, or heat keeper. Each hero makes exactly one DC 13 preparation check; resolve the result only after all three have acted. Do not run a second preparation challenge.

READ ALOUD — BEGIN THE RECONSTRUCTION

The stone hands complete their final motion. Beneath the dome, something begins to turn. First comes a soft whisking sound, then a slow golden glow. The four hearth runes ignite around the chamber. From the chimney above, claws scrape against brick. Ask each hero where they stand before the creature arrives.

The sealed reconstruction dome**READ ALOUD**

Golden light leaks beneath the sealed dome. The air smells warm, rich, and strangely familiar. Cinderdaw crawls headfirst from the chimney, scattering sparks across four glowing runes. 'Stop!' it cries. 'If the old hearth wakes, there will be nowhere left for me!' Two sootlings drop behind it and race toward separate runes. Roll initiative.

Preparation contributions

Count successes after all three heroes make one DC 13 contribution. Millkeeper's Gear can turn one failed contribution into a success. Do not confirm that the rising mixture is a cake; describe scents, warmth, and golden light.

- Arcana: stabilize the old hearth's runes.
- Investigation: align the tablet with the four component channels.
- Performance: reproduce the rhythm shown by the stone stirring hands.
- Survival or History: recognize the purpose of controlled heat and careful measures.
- Any creative action: improvise a missing tool, cool a cracked rune, or protect the covered dome.

PREPARATION RESULT — RESOLVE AFTER ALL THREE HEROES ACT

3 successes: all runes lit; Cinderdaw starts at 42 HP. 2 successes: all runes lit; Cinderdaw starts at 52 HP. 1 success: one rune starts dark; Cinderdaw starts at 52 HP. 0 successes: one rune starts dark and Cinderdaw acts first. The reconstruction is never ruined.

GM-ONLY SECTION**Finale: Cinderdaw and the Four Hearth Runes**

Use the Founder's Hearth map, four rune tokens, two sootlings, Cinderdaw, and one progress marker. The heroes win at the end of a round with 3 Reconstruction successes, by reducing Cinderdaw to 0 HP, or—after 2 successes and no earlier than round 3—by convincing it that the hearth can become its home.

Finale rules

FIRST-TIME GM — RUN EACH ROUND

1. Announce lit runes and the hero who may attempt Reconstruction. 2. Let everyone act in initiative order; only one Reconstruction attempt is allowed. 3. A sootling may attack or extinguish a rune. 4. If none does, Cinderdaw smothers one unguarded rune. 5. Check victory only after the round ends.

OPTIONAL RUNE POWERS

PEARL: healing restores +1d4 HP. MEAL: heroes cannot be pushed or knocked Prone. GOLD: the first weapon hit each round deals +1d4 Radiant damage. SWEET: heroes have Advantage on saves to avoid or end the Frightened condition. Use these for the combat-experienced group; omit them if bookkeeping slows play.

- Only one rune can be extinguished per round in total. A sootling may use Foul Rune; if none does, Cinderdaw smothers one unguarded rune at round's end. A hero beside a rune may use an action to relight it or guard it until the hero's next turn.
- Only one Reconstruction check can be attempted each round, and at least 2 runes must be lit. A hero beside the tablet uses an action for a DC 13 fitting check. A different hero must attempt each round until all three have contributed. Success marks MIX, RISE, or FINISH and relights one rune. Progress never resets.
- At 2 successes, Radiant Draft activates: Cinderdaw takes 2d8 Radiant damage, the Frightened condition ends on every hero, and one extinguished rune relights. At 3 successes, finish the current round; then the dome seals, Cinderdaw becomes a Tiny ember-drake, and combat ends.
- If fewer than 2 runes are lit, Reconstruction cannot be attempted. The townspeople's song relights Pearl at round's end if fewer than 2 remain lit. A hero who expends Heroic Inspiration to reroll a failed Reconstruction check also relights one rune, even if the reroll fails.
- After 2 Reconstruction successes and no earlier than round 3, a hero can use an action and make a DC 12 Persuasion check to offer Cinderdaw a home. On success, finish the current round and then end the fight. When Cinderdaw becomes Tiny or reaches 0 HP, ask whether the heroes banish it, let it escape, or appoint it Bellweather's hearth-keeper.

READ ALOUD — CINDERDAW'S CHOICE

The ash drake shrinks until it is no larger than a house cat. Its flames dim to a nervous glow. It looks from the bright hearth to the open chimney. 'I thought waking it would put me out,' it whispers. 'Is there room in your celebration for something made from the fire?' Stop reading. Ask the players what they offer, then choose the ending that follows their answer.

Cinderdaw, Ash Drake

Medium Elemental; AC 14; Initiative +3 (13); HP 52 (42 only after 3 preparation successes); Speed 30 ft., Climb 20 ft. Saves: Dex +5, Wis +3. Resistance to Fire damage; Immunity to the Frightened condition.

Cinder Claw. Melee Attack Roll: +5, reach 5 ft. Hit: 7 (1d8 + 3) Fire damage.

Soot Breath (Recharge 5-6). Wisdom Saving Throw: DC 13, each creature in a 15-foot Cone. Failure: 7 (2d6) Psychic damage and Frightened until the end of its next turn. Success: Half damage only.

Up the Chimney! (Reaction, once per round). Trigger: Cinderdaw is hit by an attack. Response: it climbs up to 10 feet without provoking Opportunity Attacks.

Tactics. Cinderdaw circles the hearth, targets confident heroes with Soot Breath, and commands sootlings to foul separate runes. It never attacks an unconscious hero. Its threats sound frightened: 'If the hearth wakes, where will I go?' Reveal this after round 1 or a successful DC 12 Insight check.

Sootlings (2)

Tiny elementals; AC 12; HP 5 each; Speed 25 ft., climb 25 ft.; Initiative +2. Smudging Scratch: +4 to hit, 1d4 + 2 psychic damage. Poof! At 0 HP, a sootling bursts into harmless black dust. A hero beside it may catch a golden spark and regain 1d4 HP.

KEEP IT MOVING

At the start of each round, announce lit runes, Reconstruction progress, and which hero may contribute next. If the clock slips, after round 3 advance Reconstruction to FINISH following the next successful compassionate or creative action. Finish the current round, then begin the reveal. Never grind through the last few hit points.

GM-ONLY SECTION

Epilogue, Reveal, and Easy Adjustments

The dome opens

READ ALOUD

The four runes blaze white. With a deep stone rumble, the dome rises. Beneath it stands a towering golden cake made from the Dawn Pearls, Sunmeal, Lantern Gold, and Cloudsweet—finished with shimmering decorations formed from the heroes' own magic. Mayor Mallow laughs. 'Bellweather didn't lose a treasure. We lost the recipe for celebrating together!'

Lift a bowl, box, or cloth at the table if you have prepared a real birthday cake. Beneath the stone dome stands an enormous golden cake crowned with candles. Explain how every quest component became part of it. Ask each player to narrate one decoration created by their hero, then let the birthday child name the finished cake.

Restorer's Medal

Once in a future adventure, the wearer can turn a failed check into a success by explaining what forgotten thing they remembered. Afterward, the medal becomes an ordinary brass gear.

Difficulty and age dial

Group	Checks	Final encounter
New players	Use DC 12; offer a hint after one failed attempt.	Cindermaw HP 44, or 40 after 3 preparation successes; one sootling; Pearl Rune begins guarded.
Age 13 / default	Use DC 13 and the printed challenges.	Cindermaw HP 52, or 42 after 3 preparation successes; two sootlings; one rune can be extinguished per round.
Experienced players	Use DC 14; add costs on mixed results.	Cindermaw HP 60, or 50 after 3 preparation successes; three sootlings; Gold Rune begins dark.

If the table has only two players plus a GM

Each player chooses a hero and starts with Heroic Inspiration. Use Cindermaw at 34 HP with one sootling. Sprig follows them: AC 13, HP 15; Star Bolt +4 to hit, 1d6 + 2 Radiant; Sprig can take the Help action as a Bonus Action.

Time trims

- For a two-hour game, make the moon-hen challenge 3 successes before 2 setbacks and remove the sugar-sprite fight.
- For a ninety-minute game, narrate the Windmill and Honey Steps, then run only the storehouse and Founder's Hearth finale.
- If any fight runs long, the remaining creatures surrender or bargain as soon as half are defeated and a hero offers terms.

Closing the session

Award the Restorer's Medal, ask when the players first suspected the answer, and let every hero describe one decoration before the birthday hero names the finished creation.

GM REFERENCE — EXPECT 3½ TO 4½ HOURS

Four-Hour Run Sheet

Clock	Scene	Target	End the scene when...
0:00–0:20	Bellweather Square	Meet heroes; accept commission	Every hero answers one spotlight question.
0:20–1:00	Briar Farm	Recover Dawn Pearls	Rooster is calmed or three hens fall.
1:00–1:15	BREAK 1 / SHORT REST	One-hour story transition; spend Hit Dice	Short Rest features recover; Musician can inspire allies.
1:15–2:00	Storehouse	Expose impostor; claim Lantern Gold	Correct flask is secured.
2:00–2:30	Windmill	Solve order; claim Sunmeal	Drawer opens.
2:30–3:00	Honey Steps	Earn Cloudsweet	Sprites bargain, befriend, or yield.
3:00–3:15	BREAK 2 / LONG REST	Eight-hour story transition; resume at dawn	HP, Hit Dice, spell slots, and Long Rest features recover.
3:15–3:45	Hearth Trials	Place components; each hero operates a station	All three preparation contributions are resolved.
3:45–4:20	Cindermaw Finale	Protect runes; complete or reconcile	Finish the current victory round.
4:20–4:30	Reveal	Name and celebrate the creation	Every hero adds one decoration.

AT EVERY SCENE

1. State the goal. 2. Describe what is obvious. 3. Ask every player what they do. 4. Roll only when failure changes something. 5. Give the clue or component even after a setback. 6. Announce the next destination.

IF THE CLOCK SLIPS

Do not remove a puzzle. Shorten combat: enemies bargain after half are defeated; use average damage; skip reinforcements. At the finale, Cindermaw offers terms after the next compassionate action.

Choices That Matter

Scene choice	Award	Later effect
Calm the rooster	Silver Feather	End Frightened on the whole party once.
Preserve Captain Wick's trust	Captain's Whistle	Guard one rune for a full round.
Solve the mill without magical hint	Millkeeper's Gear	Turn one failed preparation check into a success.
Make a sincere promise to sprites	Sprite's Favor	Advantage on first check to reason with Cindermaw.
Correctly predict the lost creation	Brilliant Deduction	Advantage on one Founder's Hearth check.

Three-Step Hint Ladder

Puzzle	Hint 1	Hint 2	Answer / final rescue
Windmill	Which symbol cannot be first?	Place CROWN immediately before SUN.	RIVER, RAVEN, CROWN, SUN.
Four Channels	What wakes must enter first.	Warm gold comes after form.	PEARLS, MEAL, GOLD, SWEET.
Hearth actions	Warming cannot happen before combining.	The crown must be last.	COMBINE, STIR, WARM, CROWN.

CINDERMAW FORESHADOWING

Farm: a drake silhouette watches from a chimney. Storehouse: the impostor gasps, 'The hearth leaves no room for us.' Windmill: soot reads, 'The hearth burns what it cannot remember.' Finale: Cindermaw's first words reveal fear, not hatred.

OFFLINE BINDER — DO THIS BEFORE PLAY

Ten-Minute GM Rehearsal

Minutes	Rehearse or prepare
0–2	Read the Bellweather Square and Briar Farm read-aloud boxes aloud once.
2–4	Locate the moon-hen, disguised sootling, sprite, sootling, and Cindermau stat blocks.
4–6	Lay out the Storehouse zones and practise marking 3 successes / 2 setbacks.
6–8	Place four rune tokens, MIX / RISE / FINISH, Cindermau, and two sootlings on the Hearth map.
8–10	Cover the real cake or reveal prop; rehearse lifting the cover after the final narration.

Handout Cue Strip

When	Place on the table
Hero choice	Sheets 45–50; action cards 41; Elio spell cards 42–43; quick rules 51.
Briar Farm	Act 1 handout 28 and player map 32; give the Dawn Pearls card from 30 when recovered.
Storehouse / Mill	Act 2 handout 29 and maps 33–34; give Lantern Gold and Sunmeal cards from 30.
Honey Steps	Player map 35; give the Cloudsweet card from 30 when earned.
Founder's Hearth	Tracker 31, map 36, rune/progress tokens 38, and action/loot cards 40.

BIRTHDAY & FOOD CHECK

Privately confirm allergies, dietary needs, candles, and serving plans with a parent or guardian. Keep food packaging, scent, and the covered cake away from the play table so they do not reveal the mystery.

SPOTLIGHT RULE

At every challenge, ask all three players what they intend to do before resolving the first roll. Everyone acts before anyone repeats a skill or station.

REST RESET

BREAK 1 / SHORT REST: spend Hit Point Dice; recover Short Rest features; Elio's Musician feat can grant Heroic Inspiration.
BREAK 2 / LONG REST: restore HP, Hit Point Dice, spell slots, and Long Rest features; resume at dawn.

EMERGENCY FINISH

If time runs short after round 3 of the finale, the next successful compassionate or creative action advances Reconstruction to FINISH. Complete that round, then begin the reveal.

Challenge Procedures

Storehouse: 3 Successes Before 2 Setbacks

Route	Suggested checks	A success reveals...
OFFICIAL	DC 12 Insight, Perception, Persuasion	A contradiction, soot trail, or missing shadow.
COVERT	DC 13 Stealth, Acrobatics, thieves' tools	A safe path through rafters or the roof vent.
BAIT	DC 12 Deception, Investigation, Performance	The impostor's reaction or wooden-spoon seal.

STOREHOUSE OUTCOME

3 successes: expose the impostor cleanly and preserve Wick's trust. 2 setbacks: trigger the blue-fire chase. Either result secures Lantern Gold. Award the Whistle if no real guard was harmed.

Hearth Preparation: One Check Per Hero

Successes	Finale setup
3	All runes lit; Cinderdaw starts at 42 HP.
2	All runes lit; Cinderdaw starts at 52 HP.
1	One rune dark; Cinderdaw starts at 52 HP.
0	One rune dark; Cinderdaw acts first.

MILLKEEPER'S GEAR

After all three heroes contribute, convert one failed preparation check into a success. Resolve the row above only after every hero has acted.

GM REFERENCE — KEEP VISIBLE

Finale Dashboard & Initiative Strips

PLAYER VICTORY CARD

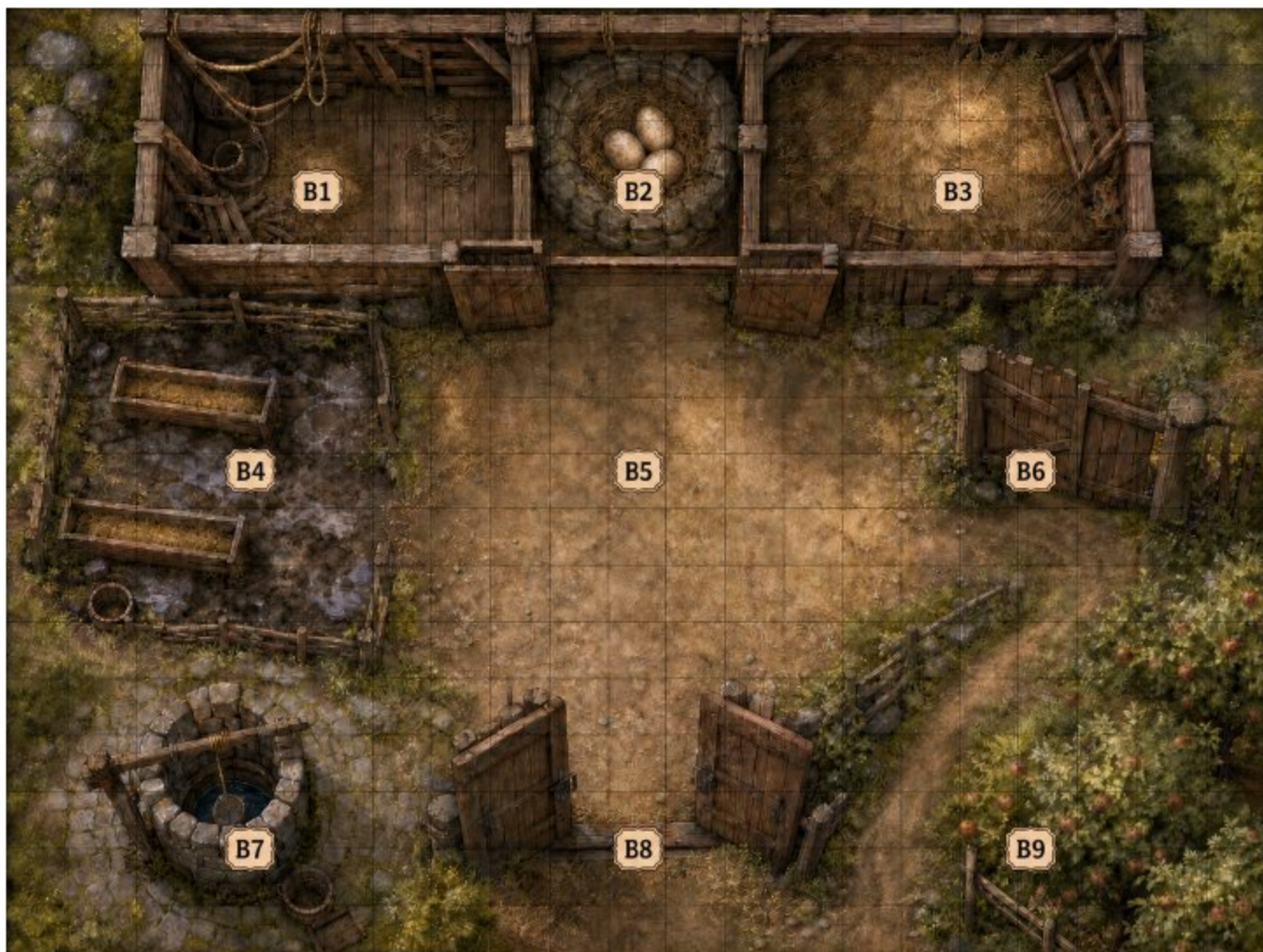
KEEP AT LEAST 2 RUNES LIT.
Complete MIX, RISE, and FINISH.
Only one different hero attempts Reconstruction each round.
After 2 successes and during round 3 or later, Cindermau can be offered a home.
Victory takes effect after everyone finishes the current round.

Round	Lit runes	Hero attempting Reconstruction	Progress / result
1	P _ M _ G _ S _	_____	_____
2	P _ M _ G _ S _	_____	_____
3	P _ M _ G _ S _	_____	_____
4	P _ M _ G _ S _	_____	_____
5	P _ M _ G _ S _	_____	_____

Initiative Strips — Cut Apart

BRAMBLE	NYX	ELIO	CINDERMAW
MOON-HENS	DISGUISED SOOTLING	SUGAR SPRITES	SOOTLINGS

✂ Cut on the cell borders and arrange the strips in initiative order.

**ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE**

B1 Rafters B2 Stone nest B3 Hayloft

B4 Troughs B5 Farmyard B6 Side gate

B7 Old well B8 Hero entrance B9 Orchard

TACTICAL SCALE: 1 square = 5 feet. Secret: feed in B3 grants Advantage to calm the rooster. Reinforcements enter from B9 only if needed.

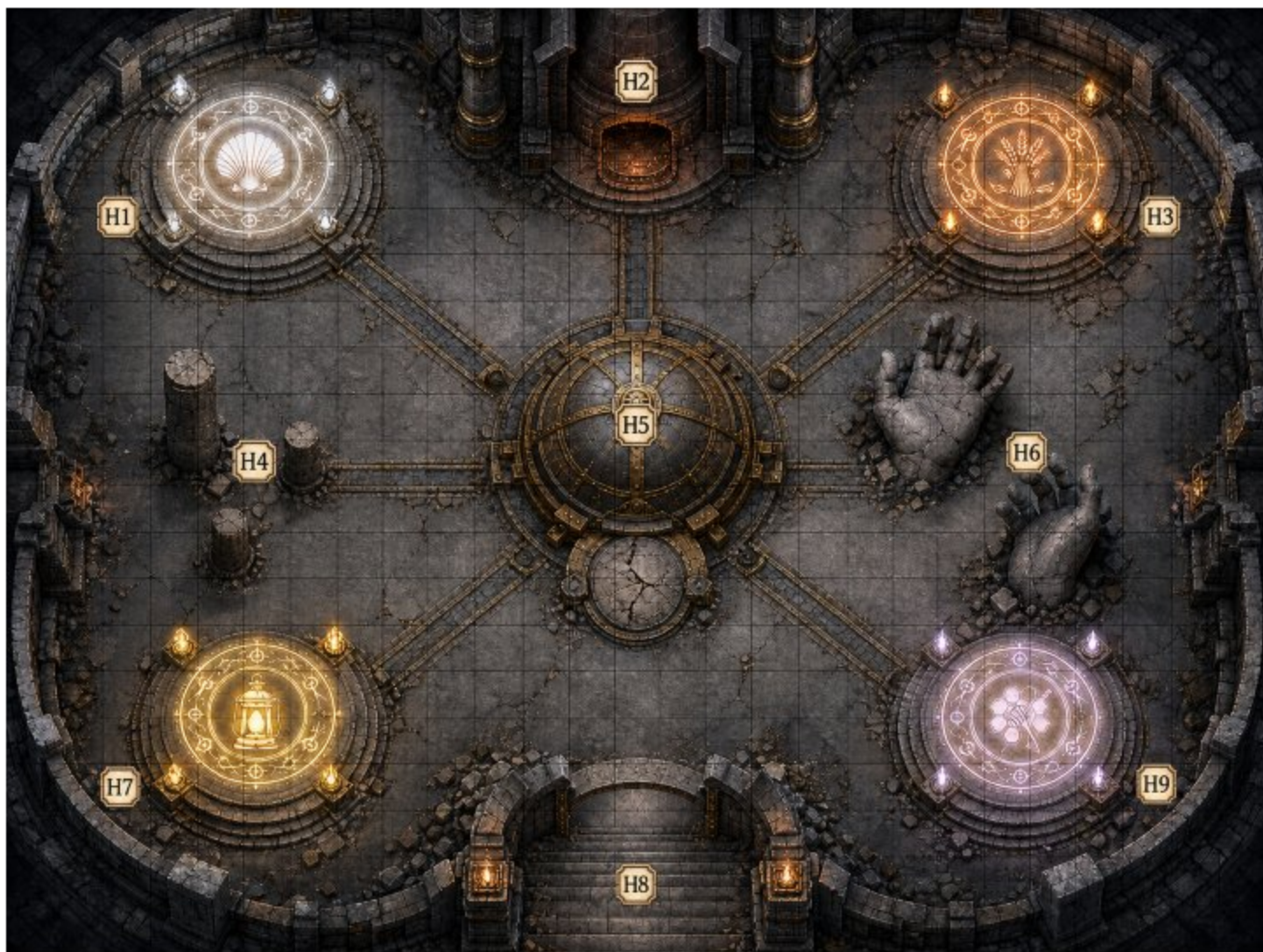
**ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE**

S1 City wall S2 Roof walk S3 Chimney

S4 Courtyard S5 Rafters S6 Oil room

S7 Front approach S8 Supply hall S9 Alley exit

TACTICAL SCALE: 1 square = 5 feet. The impostor begins in S8 and flees through S9. The S5 vent provides access toward S6.

**ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE**

H1 Pearl rune H2 Chimney H3 Meal rune

H4 Pillars H5 Dome/tablet H6 Stone hands

H7 Gold rune H8 Hero entry H9 Sweet rune

TACTICAL SCALE: 1 square = 5 feet. Start sootlings at H1 and H3, Cinderdaw at H2, and heroes at H8. Only one rune can be extinguished each round.

NPC & Creature Stat Blocks

HOW TO USE THESE

Each block contains everything needed at the table. Mark current HP beside the printed maximum. For a faster game, use average damage instead of rolling. Creatures flee, surrender, or become harmless when the story says the encounter is over.

Mayor Mallow

Medium humanoid (human), neutral good

Armor Class 10 • Initiative +0 (10) • Hit Points 9 (2d8) • Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Skills History +4, Persuasion +4 • Senses passive Perception 11 • Languages Common, Dwarvish • Challenge 0 (10 XP; PB +2)

Town Historian. Mayor Mallow has Advantage on Intelligence (History) checks about Bellweather.

Actions

Walking Stick. Melee Attack Roll: +2, reach 5 ft. Hit: 2 (1d4) Bludgeoning damage.

Rallying Word (1/Day). One creature within 30 feet gains 5 Temporary Hit Points.

Captain Wick

Medium humanoid (human), lawful good

Armor Class 16 (chain shirt, shield) • Initiative +1 (11) • Hit Points 27 (5d8+5) • Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)

Skills Insight +4, Investigation +2, Perception +4 • Senses passive Perception 14 • Languages Common • Challenge 1 (200 XP; PB +2)

Watch Captain. Friendly guards within 30 feet have Advantage on saves to avoid or end the Frightened condition.

Actions

Multiattack. Wick makes two Spear attacks.

Spear. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) Piercing damage.

Net (1/Day). Dexterity Saving Throw: DC 11, one Large or smaller creature within 15 feet. Failure: the target has the Restrained condition. The target or a creature within 5 feet of it can take an action and make a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check, freeing the target on a success.

NPC & Creature Stat Blocks — Continued

Bellweather Guard

Medium humanoid (any ancestry), any lawful alignment

Armor Class 14 (leather, shield) • Initiative +1 (11) • Hit Points 11 (2d8+2) • Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
13 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)

Skills Perception +2 • Senses passive Perception 12 • Languages Common • Challenge 1/8 (25 XP; PB +2)

Nonlethal Training. A guard reduced to 0 HP during this adventure is knocked unconscious and stable.

Actions

Spear. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +3, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. Hit: 4 (1d6 + 1) Piercing damage.

Net (1/Day). Dexterity Saving Throw: DC 11, one Large or smaller creature within 15 feet. Failure: the target has the Restrained condition. The target or a creature within 5 feet of it can take an action and make a DC 10 Strength (Athletics) check, freeing the target on a success.

Moon-Hen

Small beast, unaligned

Armor Class 12 • Initiative +2 (12) • Hit Points 7 (2d6) • Speed 30 ft., fly 10 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	7 (-2)

Skills Perception +3 • Senses passive Perception 13 • Languages — • Challenge 1/8 (25 XP; PB +2)

Flock Fury. The moon-hen has Advantage on an attack roll if another moon-hen is within 5 feet of the target.

Actions

Furious Peck. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Piercing damage.

Wing Flurry (Rooster Only; 1/Round). Dexterity Saving Throw: DC 12, each creature within 5 feet. Failure: 4 (1d4 + 2) Bludgeoning damage, and the target has the Prone condition.

NPC & Creature Stat Blocks — Continued

Disguised Sootling

Small elemental, chaotic neutral

Armor Class 13 • Initiative +2 (12) • Hit Points 13 (3d6+3) • Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	9 (-1)	11 (+0)	12 (+1)
Skills Deception +3, Stealth +4 • Damage Resistances fire • Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10 • Languages understands Common • Challenge 1/4 (50 XP; PB +2)					

False Appearance. While motionless in guard form, the sootling is indistinguishable from a guard except that it casts no shadow and leaves soot tracks.
Soot Shape. As a Bonus Action, it changes between its soot form and one humanoid disguise.

Actions

Smudging Claw. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) Psychic damage.
Blue-Fire Dash (Recharge 5–6). The sootling moves up to its Speed without provoking Opportunity Attacks.

Sugar Sprite

Tiny fey, chaotic good

Armor Class 13 • Initiative +3 (13) • Hit Points 4 (3d4-3) • Speed 10 ft., fly 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
4 (-3)	16 (+3)	9 (-1)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)
Skills Nature +2, Performance +4 • Senses passive Perception 11 • Languages Common, Sylvan • Challenge 1/4 (50 XP; PB +2)					

Flower Step. Opportunity attacks against the sprite are made with disadvantage while it is within 5 ft. of a plant.

Actions

Sugar Sting. Melee or Ranged Attack Roll: +5, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. Hit: 5 (1d4+3) Piercing damage.
Blinding Glitter (Recharge 6). Constitution Saving Throw: DC 12, one creature within 20 feet. Failure: the target has the Blinded condition until the start of the sprite's next turn.

NPC & Creature Stat Blocks — Continued

Sootling

Tiny elemental, chaotic neutral

Armor Class 12 • Initiative +2 (12) • Hit Points 5 (2d4) • Speed 25 ft., climb 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
6 (-2)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	7 (-2)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)

Damage Resistances fire • Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10 • Languages understands Ignan • Challenge 1/8 (25 XP; PB +2)

Poof! When reduced to 0 HP, the sootling bursts harmlessly. One creature within 5 ft. can catch its spark and regain 1d4 HP.

Actions

Smudging Scratch. Melee Attack Roll: +4, reach 5 ft. Hit: 4 (1d4 + 2) Psychic damage.

Foul Rune. The sootling extinguishes one unguarded hearth rune within 5 feet.

Cindermaw, Ash Drake

Medium elemental, chaotic neutral

Armor Class 14 • Initiative +3 (13) • Hit Points 52 (8d8+16) • Speed 30 ft., climb 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws Dex +5, Wis +3 • Skills Acrobatics +5, Insight +3 • Damage Resistances fire • Condition Immunities frightened • Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 11 • Languages Common, Ignan • Challenge 2 (450 XP; PB +2)

Hearthbound. If no sootling used Foul Rune this round, Cindermaw extinguishes one lit, unguarded rune at round's end. Only one rune can be extinguished per round.

Fear of Extinction. After 2 Reconstruction successes and no earlier than round 3, a creature can use an action and succeed on a DC 12 Charisma (Persuasion) check to offer Cindermaw a home. The fight ends after the current round.

Actions

Cinder Claw. Melee Attack Roll: +5, reach 5 ft. Hit: 7 (1d8 + 3) Fire damage.

Soot Breath (Recharge 5-6). Wisdom Saving Throw: DC 13, each creature in a 15-foot Cone. Failure: 7 (2d6) Psychic damage, and the target has the Frightened condition until the end of its next turn. Success: Half damage only.

Reactions

Up the Chimney. Trigger: Cindermaw is hit by an attack. Response: Cindermaw climbs up to 10 feet without provoking Opportunity Attacks.

Sprig, Lantern Sprite

Tiny fey, neutral good

Armor Class 13 • Initiative +3 (13) • Hit Points 15 (6d4) • Speed 10 ft., fly 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
5 (-3)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)

Skills Perception +4 • Damage Resistances radiant • Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 14 • Languages Common, Sylvan • Challenge 1/4 (50 XP; PB +2)

Helpful Light. Sprig can take the Help action as a Bonus Action.

Actions

Star Bolt. Ranged Spell Attack Roll: +4, range 60 ft. Hit: 5 (1d6 + 2) Radiant damage.

Kindle (1/Day). Sprig relights one hearth rune within 30 feet.

Bellweather Restoration Commission

OFFICIAL COMMISSION

Birthday Hero: _____
Recover DAWN PEARLS, SUNMEAL, LANTERN GOLD, and CLOUDSWEET. Their purpose is unknown. Return all four to the Founder's Hearth before tomorrow's sunset.

Restoration Tablet

Component	Recovered	What We Learned	Who Carries It
DAWN PEARLS	☐	_____	_____
LANTERN GOLD	☐	_____	_____
SUNMEAL	☐	_____	_____
CLOUDSWEET	☐	_____	_____

HEROIC INSPIRATION — 2024 CORE RULE

Each hero starts with Heroic Inspiration. Immediately after rolling any die, expend it to reroll that die; you must use the new roll. A hero can have only one Heroic Inspiration at a time.

Act 1: Briar Farm

WHAT YOU SEE

BARN RAFTERS — loose ropes, hanging tools, and a path above the brood.
FARMYARD — six moon-hens, scattered feed, and a furious silver-combed rooster.
STONE NEST — three warm Dawn Pearls.
SIDE GATE — warped boards and a rusty latch.

Our Plan

Hero	Position or Approach	What Could Help
------	----------------------	-----------------

Bramble

Nyx

Elio

Clue Revealed by the Tablet

BOTTLED DAYLIGHT

WHERE WATCHFUL EYES GUARD BOTTLED DAYLIGHT, CLAIM ONLY THE GOLD THAT MAY TOUCH A WOODEN SPOON.

Act 2: Storehouse & Windmill

Storehouse Infiltration

Zone	What We Know	Hero / Result
COURTYARD	Captain Wick admits the commission—but not every guard is real.	_____
RAFTERS	A roof vent overlooks the locked oil room.	_____
OIL ROOM	Gold, blue, and black flasks; only one bears a wooden-spoon seal.	_____

SUSPECT CLUES

☐ Casts no shadow ☐ Leaves soot tracks ☐ Carries blue fire ☐ Knows the wooden-spoon seal

Windmill Chute Puzzle

CARVED CLUES

RIVER comes before RAVEN.
CROWN stands immediately before SUN.
RAVEN is neither first nor last.

Open: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____ 4) _____

PLAYER HANDOUT — CUT APART IF DESIRED

Recovered Component Cards

DAWN PEARLS

Warm, speckled, and protected by the Briar Farm brood.

Carrier: _____

✂ -----

LANTERN GOLD

A golden brightseed flask bearing a wooden-spoon seal.

Carrier: _____

✂ -----

SUNMEAL

Golden powder released by the abandoned windmill.

Carrier: _____

✂ -----

CLOUDSWEET

Pale crystals carrying the memory of flowers.

Carrier: _____

✂ -----

Act 3: Founder's Hearth Tracker

Four Channels

TABLET INSCRIPTION

WHAT WAKES ENTERS FIRST.
WHAT GIVES FORM FOLLOWS.
WARM GOLD BINDS WHAT WAS DIVIDED.
MEMORY CROWNS THE WORK.

Hearth Runes

Rune	Lit?	Power While Lit	Guarded By
PEARL	● / ○	Healing restores +1d4 HP.	_____
MEAL	● / ○	Heroes cannot be pushed or knocked prone.	_____
GOLD	● / ○	First weapon hit each round deals +1d4 radiant.	_____
SWEET	● / ○	Advantage on saves to avoid or end Frightened.	_____

Reconstruction Progress

1 — MIX	2 — RISE	3 — FINISH
☐	☐ Radiant Draft!	☐ Open the dome

FINALE VICTORY RULES

Keep at least 2 runes lit. Only one different hero attempts Reconstruction each round. After 2 successes and during round 3 or later, you may offer Cindermau a home. Victory takes effect after the current round ends.



ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE

Rafters | Stone nest | Hayloft

Troughs | Farmyard | Side gate

Old well | Barn entrance | Orchard

TACTICAL SCALE: 1 square = 5 feet. Move normally on the grid. The well and barn structure provide cover; mud and troughs can slow movement.



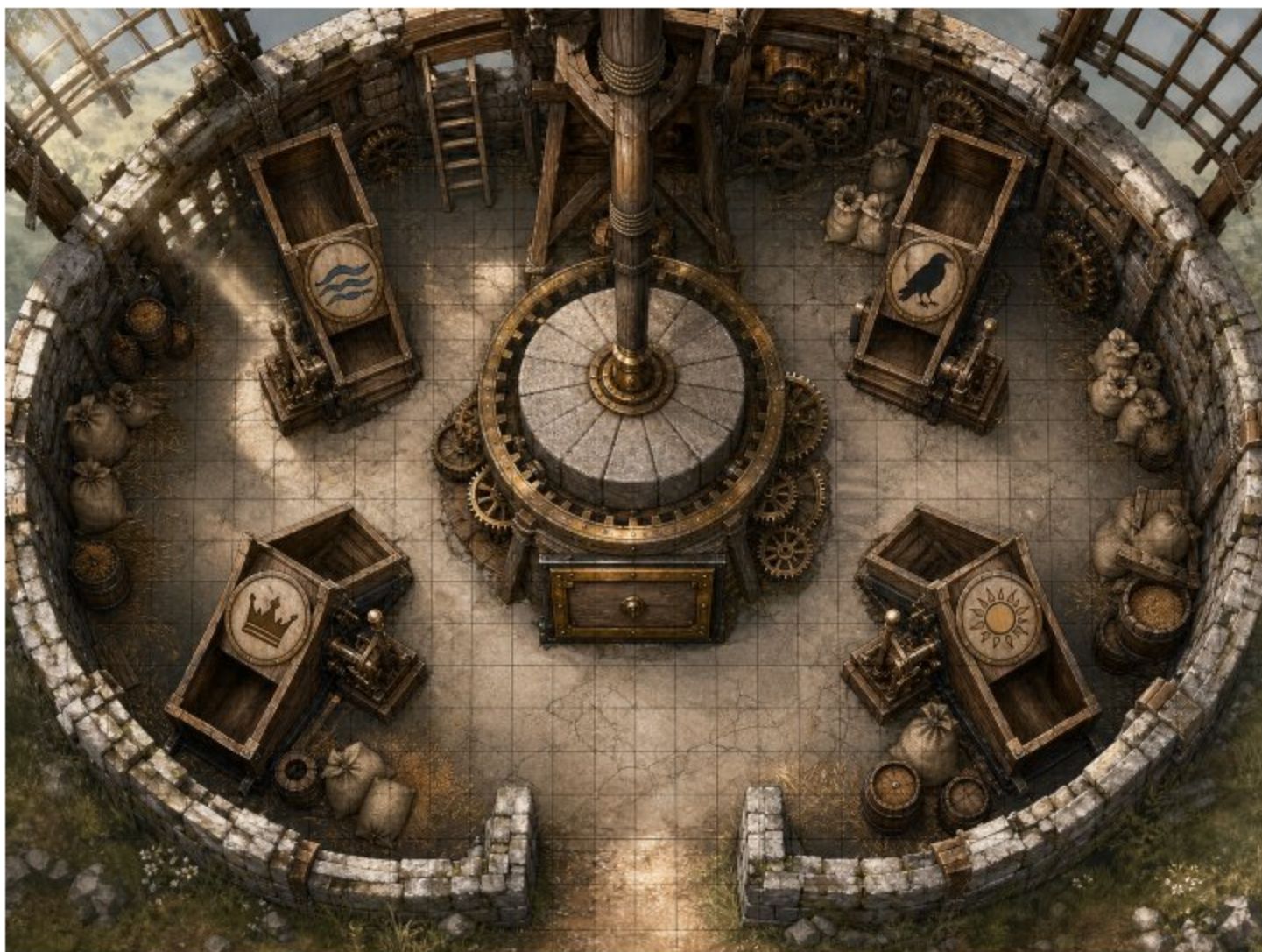
ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE

City wall | Roof walk | Chimney

Courtyard | Rafters | Oil room

Front approach | Supply hall | Alley exit

TACTICAL SCALE: 1 square = 5 feet. Open thresholds show every legal route. Ladders connect the supply hall, rafters, and roof walk.



ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE

RIVER comes before RAVEN.

CROWN stands immediately before SUN.

RAVEN is neither first nor last.

PUZZLE DIAGRAM: no tactical scale. Choose the four chute levers in order. A wrong choice releases harmless golden dust.



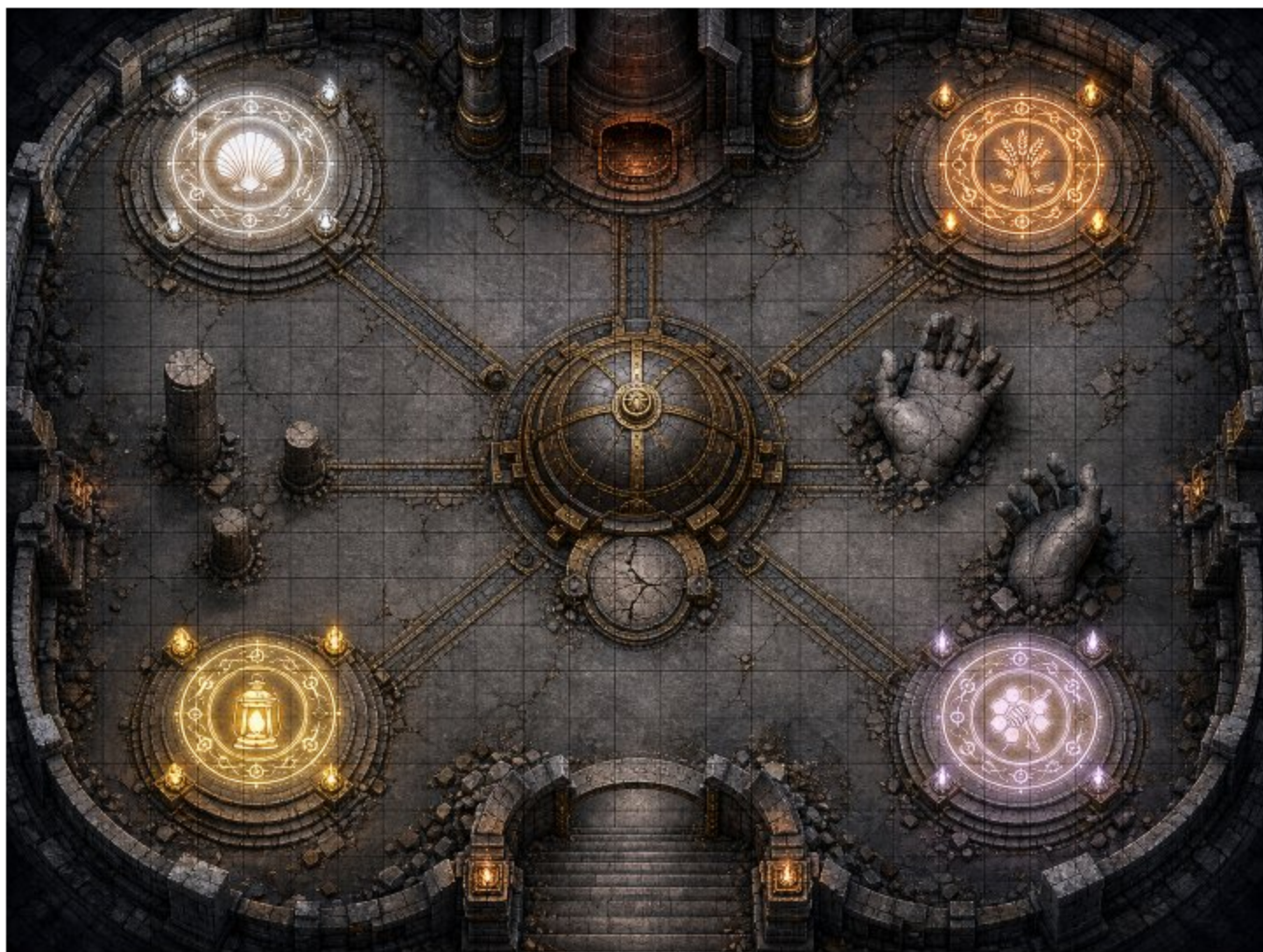
ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE

Main route: broad flower steps

Covert route: left vine path

Alternate route: right crystal steps

TACTICAL SCALE: 1 square = 5 feet when positions matter. The upper clearing supports conversation, offerings, or combat. Broad flowers near the entrance provide shelter.

**ZONE / ENCOUNTER REFERENCE**

Pearl rune | Chimney | Meal rune

Pillars | Sealed dome | Stone hands

Gold rune | Guildhall entry | Sweet rune

TACTICAL SCALE: 1 square = 5 feet. Place rune tokens at the four glowing platforms, heroes at the stairs, and the central objective at the dome.

CUT-OUT SHEET — PRINT ON CARDSTOCK IF POSSIBLE

Creature Tokens

BRAMBLE HERO	NYX HERO	ELIO HERO	CINDERMAW ASH DRAKE
ROOSTER MOON-HEN	MOON-HEN 1	MOON-HEN 2	MOON-HEN 3
MOON-HEN 4	MOON-HEN 5	SOOTLING 1	SOOTLING 2
SOOTLING 3 optional	SUGAR SPRITE 1	SUGAR SPRITE 2	SUGAR SPRITE 3

Cut along the cell borders. Fold each token or place it beneath a coin or spare miniature.

Rune, Progress & Heroic Inspiration Tokens

PEARL RUNE LIT	MEAL RUNE LIT	GOLD RUNE LIT	SWEET RUNE LIT
PEARL RUNE DARK	MEAL RUNE DARK	GOLD RUNE DARK	SWEET RUNE DARK
MIX 1 SUCCESS	RISE 2 SUCCESSES	FINISH 3 SUCCESSES	ROUND 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
HEROIC INSPIRATION BRAMBLE	HEROIC INSPIRATION NYX	HEROIC INSPIRATION ELIO	GOLDEN SPARK HEAL 1d4

Condition & Combat Tokens

BLINDED	FRIGHTENED	PRONE	RESTRAINED
POISONED	INCAPACITATED	UNCONSCIOUS	CONCENTRATION
ADVANTAGE	DISADVANTAGE	HALF COVER +2 AC / DEX	THREE-QUARTERS +5 AC / DEX
BLOODIED Half HP	HELPED	HIDDEN	REACTION USED

Hearth Action Pieces & Loot Cards

COMBINE Bring separate components together.
STIR Set the joined mixture into motion.
WARM Wake the controlled hearth.
CROWN Finish with remembered joy.
SILVER FEATHER One use: end Frightened on the whole party.
CAPTAIN'S WHISTLE One use in finale: guard one rune for a full round.
MILLKEEPER'S GEAR Turn one failed preparation check into a success.
SPRITE'S FAVOR Advantage on first attempt to reason with Cinderdaw.

CUT INTO THREE CARDS — ONE PER PLAYER

Hero Action Cards

BRAMBLE — 2024 CHAMPION

ATTACK: Longsword +5, 1d8+3 Slashing. Sap: the target has Disadvantage on its next attack before your next turn.

SECOND WIND (Bonus Action, 2 uses): regain 1d10+3 HP. Recover 1 use on a Short Rest and all on a Long Rest.

TACTICAL MIND: after a failed ability check, spend Second Wind and add 1d10; if it still fails, the use is not spent.

PROTECTION (Reaction): while holding a shield, protect an ally within 5 feet; the triggering and later attacks against that ally have Disadvantage until the start of your next turn while you remain within 5 feet.

ACTION SURGE: one extra action, except the Magic action. Javelin Slow reduces Speed 10 feet; Warhammer Push moves a Large or smaller target up to 10 feet away.

NYX — 2024 THIEF

ATTACK: Shortbow +5, 1d6+3 Piercing. Vex: after a hit that deals damage, gain Advantage on your next attack against that target before the end of your next turn.

SNEAK ATTACK: add 2d6 once per turn with Advantage, or while a conscious ally is within 5 feet of the target and you lack Disadvantage.

CUNNING ACTION (Bonus Action): Dash, Disengage, or Hide. STEADY AIM: if you have not moved, gain Advantage on your next attack this turn and then Speed 0 for the turn.

FAST HANDS (Bonus Action): pick a lock, disarm a trap, pick a pocket, take the Utilize action, or use a magic item that requires the Magic action. SECOND-STORY WORK: Climb Speed 30 feet; use Dexterity for jump distance.

DAGGER NICK: make the Light weapon extra attack inside the Attack action instead of as a Bonus Action, once per turn. ALERT: Initiative +5; may swap with a willing ally.

ELIO — 2024 LORE BARD

BARDIC INSPIRATION (Bonus Action, 3 uses): an ally within 60 feet who sees or hears you gains a d6 for 1 hour; after failing a D20 Test, they add it and might succeed. Recover all uses on a Long Rest.

CUTTING WORDS (Reaction): when a visible creature within 60 feet deals damage or succeeds on an attack roll or ability check, spend a Bardic Inspiration die and subtract the d6.

MUSICIAN: after a Short or Long Rest, grant Heroic Inspiration to up to two allies.

CANTRIP: Vicious Mockery, DC 13 Wisdom save, 1d6 Psychic. HEALING WORD (Bonus Action): 2d4+3 HP with a level-1 slot.

SPELLS: save DC 13; attack +5. Track four level-1 and two level-2 slots.

Elio's Spell Cards

MAGE HAND

Conjuration cantrip • Action • 30 ft. • V, S • 1 minute
Create a spectral hand that manipulates an unattended object. It can't attack, activate magic items, or carry more than 10 pounds.

✂ -----

VICIOUS MOCKERY

Enchantment cantrip • Action • 60 ft. • V • Instantaneous
Wisdom save DC 13. Failure: 1d6 Psychic damage and Disadvantage on the target's next attack before its next turn ends.

✂ -----

HEALING WORD

Level 1 Abjuration • Bonus Action • 60 ft. • V • Instantaneous
A creature you can see regains 2d4+3 HP. Higher slot: +2d4 per slot level above 1.

✂ -----

DISSONANT WHISPERS

Level 1 Enchantment • Action • 60 ft. • V • Instantaneous
Wisdom save DC 13. Failure: 3d6 Psychic, then the target uses its Reaction to move as far away as it safely can; this movement can provoke Opportunity Attacks. Success: half damage.

✂ -----

Elio's Spell Cards

FAERIE FIRE

Level 1 Evocation • Action • 60 ft. • V • Concentration, up to 1 minute
20-foot Cube; Dexterity save DC 13. Failed targets glow, can't benefit from Invisible, and attacks against them have Advantage.

✂ -----

THUNDERWAVE

Level 1 Evocation • Action • Self (15-foot Cube) • V, S • Instantaneous
Constitution save DC 13. Failure: 2d8 Thunder and pushed 10 feet. Success: half damage, no push.

✂ -----

SHATTER

Level 2 Evocation • Action • 60 ft. (10-foot Sphere) • V, S, M • Instantaneous
Constitution save DC 13. Failure: 3d8 Thunder. Success: half damage. Higher slot: +1d8.

✂ -----

SUGGESTION

Level 2 Enchantment • Action • 30 ft. • V, M • Concentration, up to 8 hours
Wisdom save DC 13. On a failure, the target follows a course that sounds achievable and does not obviously deal damage. Ends if you or your allies damage it.

✂ -----

REWARD CARD — CUT OUT OR KEEP WITH THE CHARACTER SHEETS

Restorer's Medal

RESTORER'S MEDAL

Wondrous Item, Uncommon (No Attunement Required)

This brass gear bears four tiny symbols: a pearl, a sheaf, a golden flask, and a flower. It grows warm when its bearer remembers something that others have forgotten.

REMEMBERED LESSON (1/ADVENTURE)

Immediately after you fail an ability check, explain what useful lesson, clue, or forgotten detail your character remembers. Turn the failed check into a success. Once this property is used, the medal becomes a nonmagical brass keepsake.

Award It at the Reveal

Give this card to the group after Bellweather's lost celebration is restored. The players decide which hero carries it if these characters return in a future adventure.

THIS ONE-SHOT

The medal is a story reward and is not needed during the current adventure. It does not replace Heroic Inspiration and requires no tracking tonight.

Bramble Stoneheart

CHARACTER NAME

Farmer

BACKGROUND

Dwarf

SPECIES

Fighter

CLASS

Champion

SUBCLASS

3

LEVEL
900
XPARMOR
CLASS

18

SHIELD

HIT POINTS

37

CURRENT

TEMP

37

MAX

HIT DICE

SPENT

3d10

MAX

DEATH
SAVES

SUCCESSIONS

FAILURES

DUNGEONS & DRAGONS

PROFICIENCY BONUS

+2

INTELLIGENCE

+0

10

MODIFIER

SCORE

- ☐ +0 Saving Throw
- ☐ +0 Arcana
- ☐ +0 History
- ☐ +0 Investigation
- ☒ +2 Nature
- ☐ +0 Religion

INITIATIVE

Adv. +1

SPEED

30 ft.

SIZE

Medium

PASSIVE PERCEPTION

13

WEAPONS & DAMAGE CANTRIPS

Name	Atk Bonus / DC	Damage & Type	Notes
Longsword	+5	1d8+3 S	Sap; versatile 1d10
Javelin	+5	1d6+3 P	Slow; range 30/120
Warhammer	+5	1d8+3 B	Push; versatile 1d10

STRENGTH

+3

17

MODIFIER

SCORE

- ☒ +5 Saving Throw
- ☒ +5 Athletics

WISDOM

+1

13

MODIFIER

SCORE

- ☐ +1 Saving Throw
- ☒ +3 Animal Handling
- ☐ +1 Insight
- ☐ +1 Medicine
- ☒ +3 Perception
- ☐ +1 Survival

DEXTERITY

+1

12

MODIFIER

SCORE

- ☐ +1 Saving Throw
- ☐ +1 Acrobatics
- ☐ +1 Sleight of Hand
- ☐ +1 Stealth

CLASS FEATURES

Fighting Style: Protection
 Second Wind (2 uses; BA, 1d10+3 HP)
 Weapon Mastery: Longsword, Javelin, Warhammer
 Action Surge (no Magic action)

Tactical Mind
 Improved Critical (19-20)
 Remarkable Athlete (Adv. Initiative/Athletics)

CONSTITUTION

+2

15

MODIFIER

SCORE

- ☒ +4 Saving Throw

CHARISMA

-1

8

MODIFIER

SCORE

- ☐ -1 Saving Throw
- ☐ -1 Deception
- ☐ -1 Intimidation
- ☐ -1 Performance
- ☐ -1 Persuasion

HEROIC
INSPIRATION

EQUIPMENT TRAINING & PROFICIENCIES

ARMOR TRAINING ☒ Light ☒ Medium ☒ Heavy ☒ Shields

WEAPONS

Simple and Martial

TOOLS

Carpenter's Tools

SPECIES TRAITS

Darkvision 120 ft.
 Dwarven Resilience
 Dwarven Toughness
 Stonecunning (Tremorsense)

FEATS

Tough (Origin Feat)
 Protection (Fighting Style Feat)

SPELLCASTING ABILITY	
	SPELLCASTING MODIFIER
	SPELL SAVE DC
	SPELL ATTACK BONUS

SPELL ATTACK BONUS

SPELL SLOTS													
Total		Expended		Total		Expended		Total		Expended			
LEVEL 1	___				LEVEL 4	___				LEVEL 7	___		
LEVEL 2	___				LEVEL 5	___				LEVEL 8	___		
LEVEL 3	___				LEVEL 6	___				LEVEL 9	___		

	Total	Expended
LEVEL 7		◆◆

LEVEL 8 

LEVEL 9 [illegible]

BACKSTORY & PERSONALITY	
A practical mason and local hero. Bramble restores what others abandon and stands between danger and friends.	
Alignment Neutral Good	

Neutral Good

LANGUAGES
Common, Dwarvish, Giant

Common, Dwarfish, Giant

[illegible]

COINS				
CP	SP	EP	CP	PP

pp

Nyx Underbough

CHARACTER NAME

Criminal

BACKGROUND

Halfling

SPECIES

Rogue

CLASS

Thief

SUBCLASS

3

LEVEL

900

XP

ARMOR
CLASS

15

SHIELD

HIT POINTS

24

CURRENT

TEMP

24

MAX

HIT DICE

SPENT

3d8

MAX

DEATH
SAVES

SUCCESSIONS

FAILURES

DUNGEONS & DRAGONS

PROFICIENCY BONUS

+2

INTELLIGENCE

+1

12

MODIFIER

SCORE

+3 Saving Throw

+1 Arcana

+1 History

+3 Investigation

+1 Nature

+1 Religion

INITIATIVE

+5

SPEED

30 ft.

SIZE

Small

PASSIVE PERCEPTION

12

WEAPONS & DAMAGE CANTRIPS

Name	Atk Bonus / DC	Damage & Type	Notes
Shortbow	+5	1d6+3 P	Vex; range 80/320
Shortsword	+5	1d6+3 P	Finesse, Light
Dagger	+5	1d4+3 P	Nick; finesse 20/60

STRENGTH

-1

8

MODIFIER

SCORE

-1 Saving Throw

-1 Athletics

WISDOM

+0

10

MODIFIER

SCORE

+0 Saving Throw

+0 Animal Handling

+0 Insight

+0 Medicine

+2 Perception

+0 Survival

DEXTERITY

+3

17

MODIFIER

SCORE

+5 Saving Throw

+5 Acrobatics

+7 Sleight of Hand

+7 Stealth

CONSTITUTION

+2

15

MODIFIER

SCORE

+2 Saving Throw

CHARISMA

+1

13

MODIFIER

SCORE

+1 Saving Throw

+1 Deception

+1 Intimidation

+1 Performance

+3 Persuasion

CLASS FEATURES

Expertise: Sleight of Hand, Stealth
 Sneak Attack 2d6 (once per turn)
 Thieves' Cant
 Weapon Mastery: Shortbow, Dagger

Cunning Action
 Steady Aim
 Fast Hands
 Second-Story Work

SPECIES TRAITS

Brave
 Halfling Nimbleness
 Luck
 Naturally Stealthy

FEATS

Alert (Origin Feat): +2 Initiative; Initiative Swap

EQUIPMENT TRAINING & PROFICIENCIES

ARMOR TRAINING Light Medium Heavy Shields

WEAPONS

Simple and Martial weapons with Finesse or Light

TOOLS

Thieves' Tools

SPELLCASTING ABILITY	
	SPELLCASTING MODIFIER
	SPELL SAVE DC
	SPELL ATTACK BONUS

SPELL ATTACK BONUS

SPELL SLOTS										
	Total	Expended		Total	Expended		Total	Expended		
LEVEL 1	<u> </u>			LEVEL 4	<u> </u>			LEVEL 7	<u> </u>	
LEVEL 2	<u> </u>			LEVEL 5	<u> </u>			LEVEL 8	<u> </u>	
LEVEL 3	<u> </u>			LEVEL 6	<u> </u>			LEVEL 9	<u> </u>	

	Total	Expended		Total	Expended		Total	Expended
LEVEL 1	_____	◆◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 4	_____	◆◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 7	_____	◆◆
LEVEL 2	_____	◆◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 5	_____	◆◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 8	_____	◆
LEVEL 3	_____	◆◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 6	_____	◆◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 9	_____	◆

[illegible]

BACKSTORY & PERSONALITY	
Belliweather is the greatest unsolved lock Nyx has ever seen. A locked door is an invitation written in metal.	
Alignment Chaotic Good	

Chaotic Good

LANGUAGES
Common, Halfling, Goblin

Common, Halfling, Goblin

[illegible]

COINS				
CP	SP	EP	GP	PP

pp

Elio Starstring

CHARACTER NAME

Entertainer

BACKGROUND

Elf (High Elf)

SPECIES

Bard

CLASS

College of Lore

SUBCLASS

3

LEVEL
900
XPARMOR
CLASS

14

SHIELD

HIT POINTS

24

CURRENT

TEMP

24

MAX

HIT DICE

SPENT

3d8

MAX

DEATH
SAVES

SUCCESSES

FAILURES

DUNGEONS & DRAGONS

PROFICIENCY BONUS

+2

INTELLIGENCE

+1

12

MODIFIER

SCORE

○ +1 Saving Throw

● +3 Arcana

● +3 History

● +3 Investigation

○ +2 Nature

○ +2 Religion

INITIATIVE

+2

SPEED

30 ft.

SIZE

Medium

PASSIVE PERCEPTION

12

STRENGTH

-1

8

MODIFIER

SCORE

○ -1 Saving Throw

○ +0 Athletics

DEXTERITY

+2

14

MODIFIER

SCORE

● +4 Saving Throw

● +4 Acrobatics

○ +3 Sleight of Hand

○ +3 Stealth

WISDOM

+0

10

MODIFIER

SCORE

○ +0 Saving Throw

○ +1 Animal Handling

● +2 Insight

○ +1 Medicine

● +2 Perception

○ +1 Survival

WEAPONS & DAMAGE CANTRIPS

Name	Atk Bonus / DC	Damage & Type	Notes
Dagger	+4	1d4+2 P	Finesse, Light, Thrown 20/60
Light Crossbow	+4	1d8+2 P	Range 80/320
Vicious Mockery	DC 13	1d6 Psychic	Wisdom save

CLASS FEATURES

Bardic Inspiration d6 (3 uses; Bonus Action)
 Spellcasting (6 prepared spells)
 Expertise: Performance, Persuasion
 Jack of All Trades

College of Lore: Bonus Proficiencies
 Cutting Words (Reaction)

CONSTITUTION

+2

14

MODIFIER

SCORE

○ +2 Saving Throw

CHARISMA

+3

17

MODIFIER

SCORE

● +5 Saving Throw

● +5 Deception

○ +4 Intimidation

● +7 Performance

● +7 Persuasion

HEROIC
INSPIRATION

EQUIPMENT TRAINING & PROFICIENCIES

ARMOR TRAINING ◆ Light ◆ Medium ◆ Heavy ◆ Shields

WEAPONS

Simple

TOOLS

Lute, Flute, Drum

SPECIES TRAITS

Darkvision 60 ft.
 Fey Ancestry
 Keen Senses: Perception
 Trance
 High Elf Lineage: Prestidigitation, Detect Magic

FEATS

Musician (Origin Feat)
 Three instrument proficiencies
 Rest song: up to 2 allies gain Heroic Inspiration

Charisma

SPELLCASTING ABILITY

+3

SPELLCASTING
MODIFIER

13

SPELL SAVE DC

+5

SPELL ATTACK
BONUS

SPELL SLOTS

	Total	Expended		Total	Expended		Total	Expended
LEVEL 1	4	◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 4	—	◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 7	—	◆◆◆◆
LEVEL 2	2	◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 5	—	◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 8	—	◆◆◆◆
LEVEL 3	—	◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 6	—	◆◆◆◆	LEVEL 9	—	◆◆◆◆

APPEARANCE

BACKSTORY & PERSONALITY

Elio searches for a song nobody remembers and believes courage grows when people celebrate together.

Alignment

Chaotic Good

LANGUAGES

Common, Elvish, Draconic

EQUIPMENT

Studded Leather, 2 Daggers, Light Crossbow,
20 Bolts, Lute, Entertainer's Pack, Costume,
15 GP

Magic Item Attunement



COINS

CP

SP

EP

GP

PP

How to Play in Five Minutes

THE D20 TEST

When an outcome is uncertain, roll a d20 and add the relevant modifier. Meet or beat the DC or Armor Class. The three D20 Tests are ability checks, saving throws, and attack rolls.

On Your Turn

- Move up to your Speed; you can split movement before and after your action.
- Take one action: Attack, Dash, Disengage, Dodge, Help, Hide, Influence, Magic, Ready, Search, Study, Utilize, or an adventure action.
- Use one Bonus Action only when a feature or spell says it is a Bonus Action.
- Use one reaction between your turns when a feature or opportunity attack permits it.

Common Rules

- Advantage: roll two d20s and use the higher. Disadvantage: use the lower.
- Critical Hit: a natural 20 on an attack rolls the attack's damage dice twice, then adds bonuses once.
- Help: choose one of your skill or tool proficiencies; a nearby ally gets Advantage on its next matching ability check before your next turn. Or distract an enemy within 5 feet to give Advantage on one ally's next attack before your next turn.
- Heroic Inspiration: after rolling any die, expend it to reroll; you must use the new roll.
- Short Rest: spend one or more Hit Point Dice and add Constitution to each die. Recover features that say Short Rest.
- Long Rest: after at least 8 in-world hours, regain all HP and spent Hit Point Dice, spell slots, and features that recover on a Long Rest.
- Concentration: after taking damage, make a Constitution save, DC 10 or half the damage taken, whichever is higher.
- At 0 HP: fall Unconscious and make Death Saving Throws. A 10+ succeeds; a 1 causes two failures; a 20 restores 1 HP. Three successes stabilize; three failures mean death. Healing wakes you.
- Creative play: state your goal, method, and what makes it possible. The GM decides whether it works or requires a roll.

TEAM REMINDER

Bramble protects allies and controls space.

Nyx scouts, solves locks, and uses Sneak Attack beside an ally.

Elio inspires early, controls enemies with magic, and heals fallen friends.